CLASSROOM BRIEFING

WHEN THE LOCK IS A PERSON

Five real breaches, told as they unfolded.



PROJECT TEAM

THE PRESENTER



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THREE TRICKS. ORDINARY NAMES.



PHISHING

Routine message hides malicious payload.



PRETEXTING

Fabricated story exploits helpful human trust.



BAITING

Tempting offer weaponizes human curiosity.



CASE 01: INDIA

COSMOS BANK PUNE

Attackers breached the ATM switch, creating a fake approval desk that bypassed the core banking system to authorize fraudulent transactions globally.

- **Rs 94 Crore:** Lost in seven hours.
- **12,000+ ATMs:** Coordinated global withdrawal.
- **Proxy Switch:** Bypassed core banking system.
- **The Flaw:** Switch lacked secondary core verification.

CASE 02: INDIA

AIIMS NEW DELHI

Ransomware infected the primary hospital network due to weak internal segmentation, forcing one of India's largest medical institutes to revert to manual paper records.

- **Ransomware:** e-Hospital servers encrypted.
- **Soft Perimeter:** Unmanaged switches exploited.
- **Paper Shift:** Manual records for two weeks.
- **The Savior:** Isolated cold backup restored data.




Twitter Headquarters

CASE 03: GLOBAL

TWITTER VIP HIJACK

Using a fabricated IT pretext, attackers convinced employees to hand over credentials to internal administrative tools, allowing them to post from verified celebrity accounts.

- **Crypto Scam:** Posted from Obama, Musk, Gates.
- **Pretexting:** Fake IT call tricked support staff.
- **Admin Tools:** Accessed without user passwords.
- **The Lesson:** Polite phone voices lack proof.

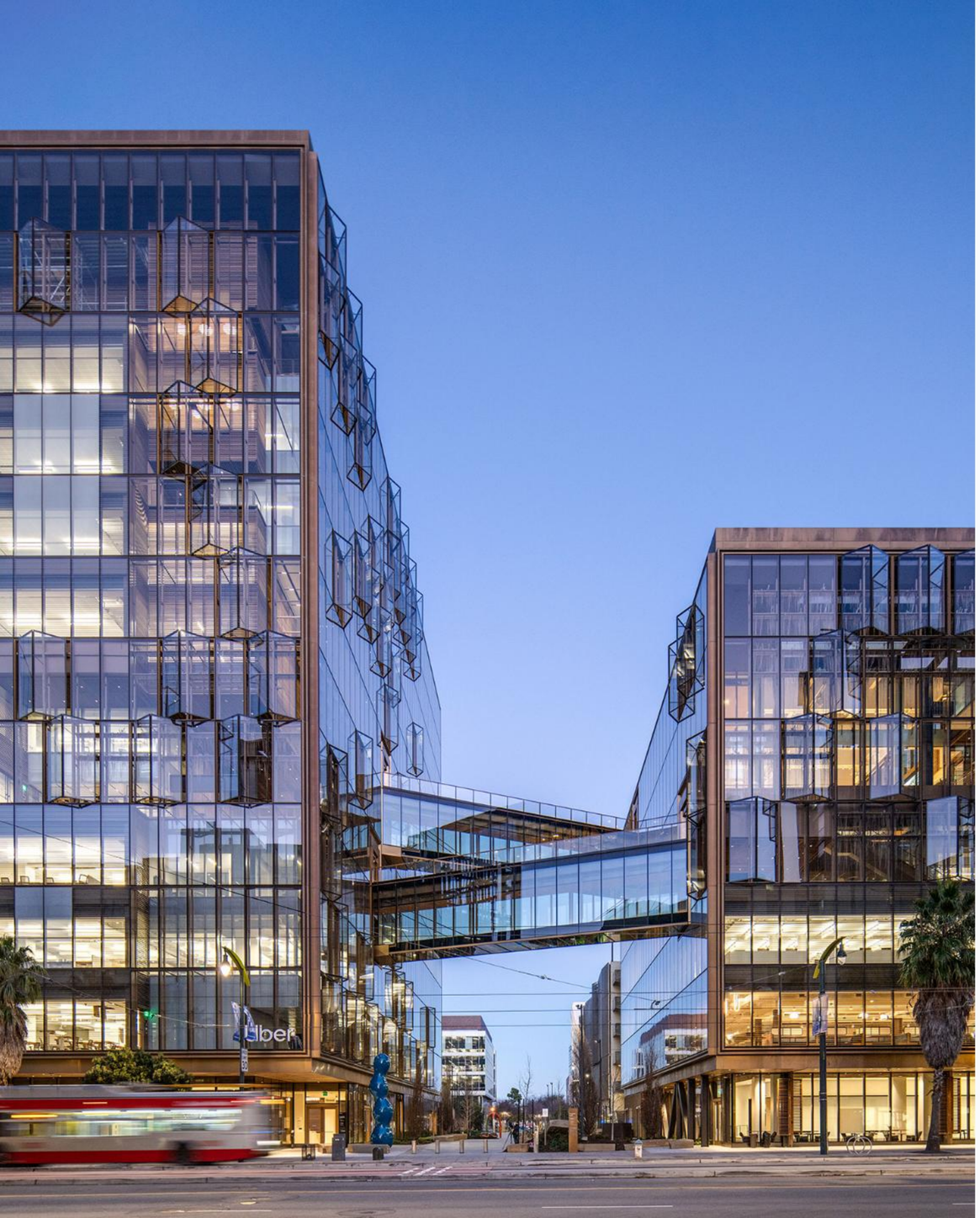
CASE 04: GLOBAL

TARGET CORPORATION

Attackers breached a third-party HVAC vendor via a phishing email, using their legitimate billing login to move laterally across Target's network and infect point-of-sale registers.

- **40M Cards:** Stolen during holiday rush.
- **Vendor Phish:** Small HVAC contractor compromised.
- **Lateral Move:** From billing portal to checkout tills.
- **Ignored Bells:** Security alerts fired but lacked owners.





CASE 05: GLOBAL

UBER BREACH

An attacker utilized 'MFA fatigue,' repeatedly bombing a contractor's phone with login approval prompts until the frustrated user finally accepted, granting full internal access.

- **MFA Fatigue:** Push-bombing defeated two-factor.
- **The Tired Yes:** Contractor approved rogue login.
- **Internal Reach:** Slack and code repositories exposed.
- **The Fix:** Denied prompts must trigger account lock.

WHAT A TIRED TUESDAY CAN CATCH

01. CALL BACK

Verify phone requests directly.

02. SEGMENT ACCESS

Isolate vendor network accounts.

03. UPGRADE MFA

Hardware keys beat yes/no buzzes.

04. OWN ALERTS

Assign owners to security bells.



THE HUMAN ELEMENT

Security depends equally on strong technology and unyielding human judgment.

QUESTIONS & DISCUSSION

IMAGE SOURCES



https://aiims.edu/images/com_fwgallery/files/806/main-building.JPG

Source: aiims.edu



https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/6/60/Twitter_Offices_in_San_Francisco.jpg?utm_source=en.wikipedia.org&utm_campaign=index&utm_content=original

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Source: www.dreamstime.com



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